

Students should have an understanding of:

3.1	The nature and purpose of Hindu yoga: the nature and purpose of different forms of yoga, karma yoga (action), jnana yoga (knowledge), astanga/raja yoga (meditation) and bhakti yoga (devotion); examples of when each form of yoga might be used, how and why; the importance of having different types of yoga; reference to Bhagavad Gita 6.44–47.
3.2	Focuses of worship and representations of the divine: the nature, purpose and importance of different ways of worshipping, including worshipping one god (personal or non-personal) or many deities, gurus and holy places (land, hills, rivers and sacred plants and animals); the scriptural basis for the different focuses of worship and representations of the divine in worship, including interpretations of Bhagavad Gita 6.20–31.
3.3	The importance of Hindu places of worship: the nature, features of, use, and purpose of worship in different places, including in the temple, in the home, outside, shrines and festival celebration and in the space of the heart, with reference to interpretations of Bhagavad Gita 9.13–27; the benefits for Hindus of having different places to worship in.
3.4*	The nature and purpose of prayer in the temple and the home: the nature, features of use and purpose of the different forms of worship, including meditation, puja, havan, darshan, arti, bhajan, kirtan and japa, with reference to interpretations of Bhagavad Gita 6.44–47; divergent understandings of the benefits for Hindus of having different forms of worship.
3.5	Hindu sacred festivals: the nature, history, purpose and significance of Hindu sacred festivals; the origins and meaning of specific festivals, including Diwali, Holi, Navratri Dussehra, Ram Navami, Ratha-yatra, Janmashtami, and Raksha Bandhan, including interpretations of Brhadaranyaka Upanishad 1.3.28.
3.6	Hindu pilgrimage: the nature, history and purpose of Hindu pilgrimages; the significance of the places Hindus go on pilgrimage; divergent understandings of why pilgrimage may, or may not be, important for Hindus today; the nature, features, history and importance of pilgrimage to the Ganges, including interpretations of Rig Veda 10.75, Vrindavana and Varanasi.
3.7	Hindu environmental projects: divergent understandings of the nature, purpose and significance of environmental care for Hindus; the importance of care for rivers and sacred places for Hindus; how Hindus care for the environment, examples of what they do and why, including reference to cow protection and interpretations of Rig Veda 10.87.16–19.
3.8	Hindu charity work: the nature and purpose of charity for Hindus; Hindu teachings about charity; the work of one named Hindu charity working to promote wellbeing, social inclusion and women's rights, what it does and why, including interpretations of Bhagavad Gita 3.10–12.

Students should have an understanding of:

4.1	Hindu teachings about the origins and value of the universe: scientific explanations for the origins of the universe and Hindu responses to them, including Rig Veda 10.129; the compatibility of Hindu beliefs and science; the value of the universe in Hinduism; divergent Hindu responses to the possible view that the universe may be used as a commodity.
4.2	Hindu teachings about the sanctity of life: why human life might be regarded as holy; how life is shown as special in the scriptures, including interpretations of Katha Upanishad 1.3.3; the importance of sanctity of life for Hindus today.
4.3	Hindu responses to scientific and non-religious explanations about the origins and value of human life, such as evolution and survival of the fittest; the significance of the responses to scientific and non-religious explanations, such as evolution and survival of the fittest, for Hindus today, including interpretations of Rig Veda 10.129.
4.4	Implications of the Hindu teachings about the value and sanctity of life for the issue of abortion: the nature of abortion; divergent Hindu teachings about abortion, including interpretations of Atharva Veda 6.113; non-religious (including atheist and Humanist) arguments surrounding its use, including the application of ethical theories, such as situation ethics, and Hindu responses to them.
4.5	Hindu teachings about life after death: Hindu teachings and beliefs that support the existence of a life after death, including Bhagavad Gita 4.23–30; divergent Hindu responses to arguments for life after death (remembered lives, paranormal, logic, reward, comfort and meeting loved ones who have passed on); the significance of belief in life after death for Hindus.
4.6	Hindu responses to non-religious arguments against life after death: why Hindus reject arguments against belief in life after death (including as a source of comfort, lack of evidence, fraudulent accounts, social control), including Bhagavad Gita 15.6–12.
4.7	Implications of the Hindu teachings about the value and sanctity of life for the issue of euthanasia: the nature of euthanasia; Hindu teachings about euthanasia, including interpretations of Bhagavad Gita 7.25–30; divergent Hindu, non-religious (including atheist and Humanist) arguments surrounding its use; the application of ethical theories, such as situation ethics, and Hindu responses to them, including support for hospice care.
4.8	Hindu responses to issues in the natural world: Hindu responses to threats to the world, including pollution, global warming and the use of natural resources; Hindu teachings about environmental care, including The Hindu Declaration on Nature – Assisi 1986 and interpretations of Bhagavad Gita 13.27–34; divergent Hindu responses to animal rights, animal experimentation and the use of animals for food, including the application of ethical theories such as utilitarianism.

Overview

This area of study comprises a study in depth of Judaism as a lived religion within the United Kingdom and throughout the world, and its beliefs and teachings on life, specifically within families, and with regard to matters of life and death.

There are four sections: Jewish Beliefs, Marriage and the Family, Living the Jewish Life and Matters of Life and Death.

The significance and importance of the various beliefs, issues and practices to Jews today should be explored throughout the sections. This should include reference to how scripture informs a Jew's understanding of the topics and how approaches to the issues are underpinned by philosophical arguments and ethical theory as applicable.

Students will be expected to study Judaism within the context of the wider British society, the religious traditions of which are, in the main, Christian. Students should compare and contrast the areas of belief and practice within Judaism with Christianity as outlined in the content below.

- Beliefs about the afterlife and their significance (1.8)*
- The practice and significance of worship (3.4)*

Students should recognise that Judaism is one of the many religions and world views in Great Britain, which include Buddhism, Hinduism, Islam, Sikhism and non-religious views such as Humanism and atheism. This knowledge may be applied throughout the assessment of the specified content.

Students should compare and contrast the areas of ethics and/or philosophy within Judaism and non-religious views as outlined in the content below.

Students should also recognise that within Judaism there may be more than one perspective in the way beliefs and teachings are understood and expressed. Common and divergent views within Judaism in the way beliefs and teachings are understood and expressed should be included throughout, including reference to Orthodox, Reform and Liberal traditions.